



Most Stolen Camera

Any guessing which DSLR camera is stolen the most, worldwide? Take a guess, then go read the article: <http://digit.in/1bfQ5bV>



Nokia Lumia 1520

Check out the Digit slideshow of the Nokia Lumia 1520 online if you intend to buy it.

extent to which we are denied different parts of the web.

Even browsing through our Facebook news feed is a controlled experience. By observing, tracking and storing our click-preferences over a period of time, Facebook algorithms would only present information that it thinks we would like – an edited fragment that would give us the illusion that the world we're a part of is exactly attuned to our views. This phenomenon of living in a bubble (read: *The Filter Bubble: What the Internet Is Hiding From You* by Eli Pariser) is no different than zoo animals who become so acclimated to captivity that the wild becomes a threat to survival.

Stop to smell the unintended consequences

Growth has a cost and it is called "unintended consequences". We know that. But none of these setbacks have hampered the drive to move forward. They have only served us lessons on how to



do so with greater care and caution – but only if we remember our past.

Just as this story was being written Google bought an advanced robotics company (Boston Dynamics) which has military contracts. Other companies like Intel are already exploring quantum and molecular processors that have the ability to break Moore's law in half. And in August the University of Washington discovered a way for a non-invasive human-to-human brain interface which



"Connectivity issues in the grave. Can I please update my FB status from here real quick?"

allowed one researcher to transmit brain signals via the internet to control the hand motions of another researcher.

Try not to be distracted by the slick user interface, the easy user experience and the immediate gratification that the system is designed to provide – in many cases by sheer force of personality (Steve Jobs circa 2007). Think and look at how the convergence of disparate technologies – in computers, robotics, biotechnology, medical sciences and even agriculture are headed towards the potential for immense fallout of unintended consequences. Combine that with the already widespread ability of algorithms made to do our thinking for us and we're left with a perplexing thought – is all this going to better humanity?

But who decides what's better anyway? Is it intrinsically better to live in sanitized environments? To rely on automation for our basic needs? To live unusually long lives thanks to technological advancements? It may seem obvious that the answer to all these questions is YES, but consider for one moment that the future can take many forms; the near egalitarian harmony of 24th century Starfleet or the ancient cruel hegemony of Battlestar Galactica. Only our level of engagement decides which one it will be.

Our own way forward

To substitute consciousness, chaos and choice with the safety of algorithmic determinism are surely the decisions of a coward and a fool. The capacity for humans to learn from an iterative evolution of thought is unparalleled by any

technology. In terms of sheer energy efficiency the human brain consumes only 20 watts per hour as compared to IBM Watson that consumes 350,000 watts. So far, we're still winning.

But more than that, even in its highest possible form (A.I.'s like Watson, Chinook, Quackle) technology can't evolve a separate ethics, morals and cultural norms. It is rigid and takes its cue from its "maker". And even though 95 percent of humans believe in a "maker" (see: god) of their own, they're free to disobey and rebel – would we be willing to extend the same ability to our silicon counterparts?

Unlikely. Since the unthinkable result of doing so is that all the data, analytics, intuitive programming, geo-location information, behaviour predictions and personal data attributes might end up in the hands of a future Skynet or worse an elite group of humans. There is no way to really know for sure. But there are surely some signs.

The human imagination can foresee its own flaws through its art and culture, and for technology, science fiction has always been an honest expression of our fears. The one thing it has taught us is that a unilateral dependency on technology that dismisses the core of humanity is fraught with failure.

As is evident from the arguments so far – the discussion over how deeply tied we are to technologies isn't filled with as many answers as it is questions – but that is the freedom we enjoy in the absence of machine control. And we can only discover answers, if we explore the world around us and not be slave to our digital avatars. 